

Word family: **can / could / cannot / can't / canned / canning**

Base word: can

Negative: cannot / can't

Past/conditional modal: could

Separate noun: can

Separate lexical verb: can / canned / canning

Useful constructions/extensions: can do, can be, can't help, can't stand, can't afford, can tell, can see, can mean, while I can, as ... as can be, canned food, a can of..., can food, get canned

Part of speech: modal verb (情態動詞) / noun (名詞) / lexical verb (一般動詞)

Your passage contains:

> "I want to learn from her **while I can**."

Here, **can** means:

to have the opportunity, possibility, or circumstances needed to do something.

Meaning in this passage

In:

> **while I can**

the speaker means:

> while I still have the chance to learn from her.

The grandmother is getting older, so the opportunity is:

* valuable;

* limited;

* not guaranteed to continue forever.

Meaning: To have the present opportunity or possibility to do something.

繁體中文: **趁現在還有機會 / 還能做到的時候**

中文翻譯:

> "I want to learn from her while I can."

「趁現在**還有機會 / 還能向她學習的時候**，我想多向她學習。」

So:

****while I can = 趁我現在還可以 / 還有機會的時候****

This is the exact passage meaning.

1. ****can = have the ability to do something (有能力) — 能 ; 會****

This is the most familiar modal meaning.

****Meaning:**** To possess the physical, mental, or learned ability needed to perform an action.

Practice 1

> “She ****can swim**** very well.”

「她很****會游泳****。」

Practice 2

> “I ****can carry**** this bag.”

「我****拿得動****這個袋。」

****can = 具有完成某項行動所需的能力****

2. ****can = know how to do something (會做 / 懂得) — 會 ; 懂****

A common learned-skill subtype.

Practice 3

> “He ****can speak**** three languages.”

「他****會說****三種語言。」

Practice 4

> “Can you drive?”

「你****會開車嗎****？」

****can + learned skill = 已掌握某項技能，知道怎樣做****

This remains closely related to general ability.

3. ****can = physically able to (身體上能夠) — 能夠；做得到****

Practice 5

> “She ****can walk**** short distances.”

「她可以****走一小段路****。」

Practice 6

> “I **can't** lift this box.”

「我****搬不動****這個箱子。」

****can = 身體條件允許進行某項行動****

4. ****can = mentally/intellectually able to (理解 / 思考能力上能) — 能夠****

Practice 7

> “I ****can understand**** the main idea.”

「我****能理解****主要意思。」

Practice 8

> “Can you remember his name?”

「你****記得起****他的名字嗎？」

****can = 認知、記憶或理解能力足以完成某事****

5. ****can = have the opportunity/chance (有機會) — 可以；有機會****

This is the exact branch used in your passage.

Practice 9 — Original

> “I want to learn from her **while I can**.”

「趁我**還有機會**，我想多向她學習。」

Practice 10

> “Visit your family **when you can**.”

「**有機會的時候**就去探望家人。」

Practice 11

> “Call me when you can.”

「你**方便 / 有機會時**打電話給我。」

can = 外在情況、時間或機會允許某件事發生

6. **while you can (趁還可以) — 趁還有機會**

A major fixed construction.

Practice 12

> “Enjoy the time together **while you can**.”

「**趁現在還可以**，好好享受相處的時間。」

Practice 13

> “Ask questions while you can.”

「**趁還有機會**就多問問題。」

while you can = 趁機會、能力或條件尚未消失之前

This carries a strong sense that the opportunity may not last.

7. **can = be possible (有可能) — 可能；會**

A major modal meaning.

****Meaning:**** Something is possible in general or under certain circumstances.

Practice 14

> “Life ****can be difficult****.”

「人生****有時會很困難****。」

Practice 15

> “Small actions ****can make**** a big difference.”

「小小的行動****可以帶來****很大的改變。」

****can = 某件事有可能發生 / 在某些情況下會如此****

8. ****can be + adjective (有時可能是.....) — 可能 ; 可以是****

Practice 16

> “Older people ****can be very active****.”

「年長人士****也可以很活躍****。」

Practice 17

> “This job can be stressful.”

「這份工作****有時可能很有壓力****。」

****can be = 表示某種性質 / 狀態具有可能性，而非一定如此****

9. ****can happen (有可能發生) — 可能發生****

Practice 18

> “Mistakes ****can happen****.”

「錯誤****有可能發生****。」

Practice 19

> “Unexpected problems can occur.”

「意料之外的問題**可能會出現**。」

can = general possibility ; 表示某事有發生的可能

10. **can = permission (可以 ; 獲准) — 可以 ; 准許**

A major modal meaning.

Practice 20

> “You **can leave** now.”

「你現在**可以離開了**。」

Practice 21

> “Can I use your phone?”

「我**可以用**你的電話嗎？」

can = 表示某人獲准 / 詢問是否獲准做某事

Common in everyday speech.

11. **Can I...? (我可以.....嗎 ?) — 請求許可**

Practice 22

> “**Can I sit here?**”

「我**可以坐這裡嗎？**」

Practice 23

> “Can I ask you something?”

「我**可以問你一件事嗎？**」

****Can I...? = 非正式而非常常見的許可請求****

12. ****You can... (你可以.....) — 給予許可****

Practice 24

> “You ****can go home**** now.”

「你現在****可以回家了****。」

Practice 25

> “You can use my desk.”

「你****可以用****我的書桌。」

****you can = 表示說話者允許對方做某事****

13. ****can = request (可以幫我.....嗎?) — 請求****

In questions, ****can**** often asks someone to perform an action rather than literally asking about ability.

Practice 26

> “****Can you help me?****”

「你****可以幫我嗎? ****」

Practice 27

> “Can you open the window?”

「你****可以幫我打開窗嗎? ****」

****Can you...? = 常用來禮貌地請別人做某事****

The literal ability meaning is usually not the real communicative purpose.

14. **can = offer/suggestion (可以.....) — 可以考慮；可選擇**

A common conversational use.

Practice 28

> “We **can meet tomorrow** if you prefer.”

「如果你想，我們**可以明天見面**。」

Practice 29

> “You can try asking her directly.”

「你**可以試試**直接問她。」

can = 提出一個可行選項、建議或安排

15. **can = option/choice (可選擇) — 可以**

Practice 30

> “You **can take the bus or walk**.”

「你**可以坐巴士，也可以走路**。」

Practice 31

> “We can stay here if you want.”

「如果你想，我們**可以留在這裡**。」

can = 某個選項在目前情況下可行

16. **can = general characteristic / tendency (有時會) — 會；可能會**

Practice 32

> “He **can be impatient** sometimes.”

「他有時**會很沒耐性**。」

Practice 33

> “Children can be surprisingly wise.”

「孩子有時**可以出乎意料地有智慧**。」

can = 表示某人 / 某物在某些情況下具有某種傾向或特徵

Not:

> always.

17. **can = theoretical/general possibility (一般可能性) — 有可能**

Practice 34

> “Too much stress **can affect** sleep.”

「壓力過大**可能影響**睡眠。」

Practice 35

> “Kindness can change people.”

「善意**可以改變**人。」

can = 根據一般規律 / 經驗，某結果有可能出現

18. **can't = inability (不能 ; 做不到) — 無法 ; 不會**

The negative of ability.

Practice 36

> “I **can't lift** it.”

「我**搬不動**它。」

Practice 37

> “She can't swim.”

「她**不會游泳**。」

can't = 缺乏進行某動作所需的能力

19. **can't = not permitted (不可以) — 不准 ; 不能**

Practice 38

> “You **can't park here**.”

「這裡**不可以停車**。」

Practice 39

> “Students can't use phones during the exam.”

「學生考試期間**不准用手機**。」

can't = 規則 / 權限不允許

20. **can't = impossible (不可能) — 不可能**

A major inferential use.

Practice 40

> “That **can't be true**.”

「那**不可能是真的**。」

Practice 41

> “He can't be at home—his car is gone.”

「他**不可能在家**，因為他的車不在。」

can't = 說話者根據證據判斷某事不可能為真

This is not inability.

21. **can't have + past participle (過去不可能.....) — 不可能曾經**

Practice 42

> “She **can't have forgotten**.”

「她**不可能忘記了**。」

Practice 43

> “They can't have finished already.”

「他們**不可能已經完成了**。」

can't have done = 根據目前證據推斷某件過去事情不可能發生過

22. **can't help + -ing (忍不住) — 忍不住；不由自主**

A major fixed expression.

Practice 44

> “I **can't help smiling** when I see her.”

「我看見她時**忍不住微笑**。」

Practice 45

> “She couldn't help laughing.”

「她**忍不住笑了**。」

can't help doing = 無法阻止自己做某事；並非真的需要別人『幫忙』

23. **can't help but + verb (不得不 / 忍不住) — 不禁；忍不住**

Practice 46

> “I **can't help but admire** her.”

「我**不禁敬佩**她。」

Practice 47

> “You can’t help but notice the difference.”

「你**不可能不注意到 / 不禁會注意到**這個差別。」

can’t help but do = 無法避免產生某種反應 / 做某事

24. **can’t stand (受不了) — 無法忍受**

A major idiomatic construction.

Practice 48

> “I **can’t stand** the noise.”

「我**受不了**這些噪音。」

Practice 49

> “She can’t stand being ignored.”

「她**無法忍受**被人忽視。」

can’t stand = 非常不喜歡 / 無法忍受某人、某物或某情況

Not about physical standing.

25. **can’t bear (無法忍受) — 受不了**

A closely related modal construction.

Practice 50

> “I **can’t bear** to see her upset.”

「我**不忍心 / 受不了**看見她難過。」

Practice 51

> “He can’t bear the thought of leaving.”

「他**無法忍受**想到要離開。」

can't bear = 情感上無法忍受某件事

26. **can't afford (負擔不起) — 沒有條件；承受不起**

A major fixed construction.

Practice 52

> “I **can't afford** a new car.”

「我**買不起**新車。」

Practice 53

> “We can't afford to waste time.”

「我們**不能承受浪費時間的後果 / 不能浪費時間**。」

can't afford = 財力不足，或某行動的代價 / 風險太高而不能做

27. **can't wait (迫不及待) — 等不及；非常期待**

A very common idiom.

Practice 54

> “I **can't wait** to see her.”

「我**迫不及待想見她**。」

Practice 55

> “We can't wait for the holiday.”

「我們**非常期待**假期。」

can't wait = 非常期待某事；不是字面上完全沒有等待能力

28. **can tell / can see / can hear (能看出 / 聽出 / 判斷) — 能夠察覺**

A common perception construction.

Practice 56

> “I **can tell** she is tired.”

「我**看得出**她累了。」

Practice 57

> “I can hear someone outside.”

「我**聽得到**外面有人。」

can + perception verb = 具備感知 / 察覺某事的能力或當前條件

29. **can = achieve / manage (能做到) — 做得到**

Practice 58

> “You **can do it**.”

「你**做得到**。」

Practice 59

> “I think we can finish today.”

「我覺得我們今天**能完成**。」

can = 具有完成目標所需能力 / 條件

30. **can do (可以做到 / 沒問題) — 能做 ; 可以**

A common informal response.

Practice 60

> “‘Can you send it today?’ ‘**Can do.**’”

「『你今天可以寄出嗎？』 『**沒問題。**』 」

Practice 61

> “Please call me later.” “Can do.”

「『晚點打電話給我。』 『**可以 / 沒問題。**』 」

Can do. = 非正式表示同意並確認自己能完成要求

31. **cannot but + verb (不得不) — 不能不 ; 只好**

A formal construction.

Practice 62

> “We **cannot but admire** her courage.”

「我們**不能不敬佩**她的勇氣。」

Practice 63

> “I cannot but agree.”

「我**不得不同意**。」

cannot but do = 無法不做 ; 正式表示某反應幾乎不可避免

More formal than:

> can't help but.

32. **can = noun: metal container (金屬罐) — 罐 ; 罐頭容器**

Now we reach a completely separate lexical word.

Meaning: A metal container, often cylindrical, used to hold food, drink, paint, etc.

Practice 64

> “He opened a **can of soup**.”

「他打開了一**罐湯**。」

Practice 65

> “There are three cans of beans.”

「有三**罐豆**。」

****a can = 用金屬製成、用來盛裝食物、飲品或其他物品的容器****

This has no semantic connection for learners with modal ****can****.

33. ****a can of + food/drink (罐裝.....) — 一罐****

Practice 66

> “She bought a ****can of tomatoes****.”

「她買了一**罐番茄**。」

Practice 67

> “He drank a can of soda.”

「他喝了一**罐汽水**。」

****a can of X = 一個裝有某食物 / 飲品的金屬罐****

34. ****can = contents of one can (一罐的量) — 一罐份量****

Practice 68

> “Add one ****can**** of coconut milk.”

「加入一**罐**椰奶。」

Practice 69

> “We used two cans of beans.”

「我們用了兩**罐**豆。」

****can = 以罐作為計量單位，指一整罐內容物****

35. ****can = verb: preserve food in cans (把食物裝罐保存) — 罐藏；製成罐頭****

A separate lexical verb.

Practice 70

> “They ****can fruit**** for the winter.”

「他們把水果****製成罐頭保存****過冬。」

Practice 71

> “The tomatoes are canned locally.”

「這些番茄在本地****裝罐保存****。」

****can food = 把食物密封在罐中保存****

36. ****canned food (罐頭食品) — 罐裝食品****

A major derivative.

Practice 72

> “We keep some ****canned food**** at home.”

「我們家裡存了一些****罐頭食品****。」

Practice 73

> “Canned tomatoes are useful for cooking.”

「****罐裝番茄****很適合煮食。」

****canned = 經密封裝罐保存的****

37. ****canned drink (罐裝飲品) — 罐裝的****

Practice 74

> “The machine sells **canned drinks**.”

「這部機器售賣**罐裝飲品**。」

Practice 75

> “Canned coffee is popular in some countries.”

「**罐裝咖啡**在一些國家很受歡迎。」

canned = 裝在金屬罐中出售的

38. **can = dismiss from a job (解僱；非正式) — 炒魷魚；開除**

A genuinely separate informal verb sense.

Practice 76

> “He was **canned** after repeated mistakes.”

「他因多次犯錯而被**解僱**。」

Practice 77

> “The company canned several managers.”

「公司**解僱了**幾名經理。」

can someone = 非正式美式英語；解僱某人

Informal.

39. **can = cancel/stop a project or plan (取消；腰斬；非正式) — 取消；停止**

A related informal sense.

Practice 78

> “They **canned the project**.”

「他們把這個項目**取消 / 腰斬了**。」

Practice 79

> “The show was canned before production began.”

「節目在製作開始前就被**取消**了。」

can a project/show/plan = 非正式地停止、取消或放棄某個計劃 / 製作

40. **the can (廁所 ; 俚語) — 廁所**

A slang noun use, especially American English.

Practice 80

> “Where’s the **can**?”

「**廁所**在哪裡？」

Practice 81

> “He went to the can.”

「他去了**廁所**。」

the can = 廁所 ; 非常非正式 / 俚語

Recognition is useful; active use is less important for learners.

41. **in the can (已完成製作 ; 影視) — 已拍攝完成**

A useful media idiom.

Practice 82

> “The film is finally **in the can**.”

「這部電影終於**拍攝完成了**。」

Practice 83

> “Once the final scene was in the can, the team celebrated.”

「最後一幕**拍完**後，團隊便慶祝。」

in the can = 電影 / 節目等已完成拍攝、內容已錄製完成

Originally linked to film being stored in cans.

42. **can of worms (棘手而複雜的問題) — 一大堆麻煩**

A major idiom from the noun **can**.

Practice 84

> “That question opened a **can of worms**.”

「那個問題引出了一**大堆複雜麻煩**。」

Practice 85

> “Changing the rule could open a can of worms.”

「改變規則可能會引發**一連串棘手問題**。」

open a can of worms = 引發原本隱藏、複雜而難處理的一系列問題

43. **kick the can down the road (把問題拖延) — 把問題延後處理**

A useful idiom.

Practice 86

> “We can’t keep **kicking the can down the road**.”

「我們不能一直**把問題拖下去**。」

Practice 87

> “The decision merely kicked the can down the road.”

「這個決定只不過是**把問題延後處理**。」

****kick the can down the road = 暫時拖延問題，而不是徹底解決****

Important distinction: **can = ability vs can = opportunity**

Compare:

> “I ****can swim****.”

= 我會游泳。

This is ****ability****.

But:

> “I’ll visit when I ****can****.”

= 我有機會 / 方便時會去。

This is ****opportunity/circumstances****.

Your passage uses the second concept.

Important distinction: **can = ability vs permission**

Compare:

> “She can drive.”

= 她會開車。

versus:

> “She can leave now.”

= 她現在可以離開了。

The first means:

> ability.

The second means:

> permission.

Important distinction: ****Can I...? vs Am I able to...?****

> “Can I leave early?”

usually means:

> 「我可以提早走嗎？」

> permission.

It normally does ****not**** ask:

> “Do I physically possess the ability to leave?”

Pragmatic meaning matters.

Important distinction: ****Can you...? ability vs request****

Compare:

> “Can you swim?”

= 你會游泳嗎？

This asks about ability.

But:

> “Can you close the door?”

usually means:

> 可以幫我關門嗎？

This is a request.

Same grammar, different communicative function.

Important distinction: ****can vs may — permission****

Traditional grammar sometimes distinguishes:

can

= ability

may

= permission

But modern everyday English commonly uses:

> “Can I...?”

for permission.

May I...? is more formal/polite.

So:

> Can I come in?

is perfectly normal modern English.

Important distinction: **can vs may — possibility**

can

often expresses:

> general/theoretical possibility.

> “It can get cold here.”

may

often expresses:

> possibility in a particular case.

> “It may rain tonight.”

This is a useful tendency, not an absolute rule.

Important distinction: **can vs could — ability**

Present/general:

> “I can swim.”

Past general ability:

> “I could swim when I was five.”

Could often functions as past of ability **can**.

Important distinction: **can vs could — requests**

Can you help me?

= normal polite request.

Could you help me?

= usually softer/more polite or tentative.

Both are very common.

Important distinction: **can vs be able to**

These overlap in ability.

can

= ordinary modal.

be able to

= useful where **can** has no required grammatical form.

For example:

> “I want to **be able to** help.”

not:

> ✗ “I want to can help.”

And:

> “I have been able to...”

because modal ****can**** has no infinitive or participle forms.

Important distinction: **can** vs know how to****

**can drive******

= able to drive.

**know how to drive******

= possess the knowledge/skill.

Usually very close, though ****can**** can additionally depend on current circumstances.

Someone may know how to drive but:

> can't drive today because of an injury.

Important distinction: **can** = possibility vs will****

**can******

= something is possible.

**will******

= predicts/states future occurrence more strongly.

> “It can happen.”

= it is possible.

> “It will happen.”

= speaker expects/asserts it will happen.

Very different certainty.

Important distinction: **can be vs is**

> “She **can be impatient**.”

= 她有時會沒耐性。

> “She **is impatient**.”

= describes impatience as a more direct/general characteristic.

Can be is less absolute.

Important distinction: **can't = inability vs prohibition**

> “I can't swim.”

= 我不會游泳。

> “You can't smoke here.”

= 這裡不准吸煙。

Same negative modal, different source of restriction.

Important distinction: **can't = prohibition vs mustn't**

can't

= not allowed.

mustn't

= strong prohibition / must not.

> “You can't enter.”

= you are not allowed.

> “You mustn’t touch that.”

= strong instruction not to do it.

They overlap but tone differs.

Important distinction: **can’t be = impossible inference vs isn’t**

> “He **isn’t** home.”

= states he is not home.

> “He **can’t be** home.”

= speaker concludes from evidence that it is impossible/highly implausible he is home.

The second is an inference.

Important distinction: **can’t help doing vs can’t do**

> “I can’t stop laughing.”

= I am unable to stop.

> “I can’t help laughing.”

= I cannot prevent myself from laughing.

The idiom means:

> 忍不住.

Important distinction: **can’t stand vs cannot stand physically**

Compare:

> “I can’t stand the noise.”

= 我受不了噪音。

versus:

> “I can’t stand.”

= 我站不起來 / 無法站立。

Same words, radically different meaning depending on the object.

Important distinction: **can’t afford = money vs consequences**

Literal financial:

> “I can’t afford the car.”

= 買不起。

Figurative:

> “We can’t afford to lose.”

= 我們承受不起失敗的後果。

So **afford** is not always about money.

Important distinction: **can’t wait literal vs idiomatic**

Literal:

> “I can’t wait any longer.”

= 我不能再等了。

Idiomatic:

> “I can’t wait to see you.”

= 我迫不及待想見你。

Context determines whether the phrase expresses inability to wait or excitement.

Important distinction: **while I can vs while I am able**

Both can refer to ability, but your passage is broader.

> **while I can**

naturally combines:

- * opportunity;
- * circumstances;
- * time;
- * ability.

So translating it merely as:

> 「趁我有能力」

would be too narrow.

Here the best meaning is:

> **趁現在還有機會**

Important distinction: **can — modal vs can — container**

These are separate lexical words.

Modal:

> “I can help.”

= 我可以幫忙。

Noun:

> “a can of soup”

= 一罐湯。

They share spelling and pronunciation but not meaning.

Important distinction: **can** — container vs **tin**

Regional vocabulary matters.

can

is especially common in American English.

tin

is common in British English for some metal food containers:

> a tin of beans.

But British English also uses **can**, particularly for drinks:

> a can of cola.

Important distinction: **can food** vs **canned food**

can food

as a verb phrase:

> preserve food in cans.

canned food

as adjective + noun:

> food already preserved in cans.

Different grammar.

Important distinction: **canned** = preserved vs **canned** = dismissed/cancelled

Compare:

> “canned tomatoes”

= 罐裝番茄.

> “He got canned.”

= 他被炒魷魚了.

> “The project was canned.”

= 項目被取消了.

Same form, completely different senses.

Important distinction: **can someone vs fire someone**

fire someone

= common informal/neutral American expression for dismissing from employment.

can someone

= more informal/slangy.

> “He got canned.”

has a casual tone.

Important distinction: **can a project vs cancel a project**

cancel

= neutral standard term.

can

= informal; stop/drop a project, production, show, etc.

Learners should understand **can** here but normally use **cancel** in formal writing.

Important distinction: **can of worms vs problem**

problem

= any difficulty.

can of worms

= a situation containing many interconnected, hidden, complicated problems.

Opening it often makes the situation much harder.

Family-extension sweep

The practical **can** family is exceptionally rich because it combines modal polyfunctionality with unrelated noun/verb meanings:

- * **can — ability** = 能 / 會
- * **can — learned skill** = 會做
- * **can — opportunity** = 有機會 / 有條件
- * **while I can** = 趁還有機會
- * **can — possibility** = 可能 / 會
- * **can be** = 有時可以是 / 可能是
- * **can — permission** = 可以 / 獲准
- * **Can I...?** = 我可以.....嗎？
- * **Can you...? — request** = 你可以幫我.....嗎？
- * **can — option/suggestion** = 可以考慮 / 可選
- * **can't — inability** = 不能 / 不會
- * **can't — prohibition** = 不可以 / 不准
- * **can't be** = 不可能是
- * **can't have done** = 不可能曾經.....
- * **can't help doing** = 忍不住
- * **can't help but do** = 不禁 / 不能不
- * **can't stand** = 受不了
- * **can't bear** = 無法忍受
- * **can't afford** = 負擔不起 / 承受不起
- * **can't wait** = 迫不及待
- * **can do** = 可以 / 沒問題
- * **cannot but** = 不得不 / 不能不 (較正式)
- * **a can** = 金屬罐
- * **a can of X** = 一罐.....
- * **can food** = 把食物裝罐保存
- * **canned food** = 罐頭食品
- * **can someone** = 解僱某人 (非正式)
- * **can a project/show** = 取消 / 腰斬 (非正式)
- * **the can** = 廁所 (俚語)

* **in the can** = 已完成拍攝
 * **open a can of worms** = 引出一大堆複雜問題
 * **kick the can down the road** = 把問題拖延到以後

The main semantic/function branches are:

- > **ability**
- > **opportunity**
- > **possibility**
- > **permission**
- > **request / suggestion**
- > **negative modal meanings and fixed expressions**

plus the unrelated lexical word:

- > **can = container / preserve in a container / dismiss or cancel informally**

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
-----	-----
can — ability	具備完成某項動作所需的身體、智力或技能能力
can — learned skill	已掌握某項技能，知道怎樣進行
can — opportunity	時間、情況或機會允許某件事發生
while I can	趁能力、時間或機會尚未消失之前
can — possibility	某件事情在一般情況下有可能發生 / 成立
can be	表示某種性質或狀態有時可能出現，而非一定如此
can — permission	某人獲准進行某項行動
Can I...?	非正式而常見地請求許可
Can you...? — request	禮貌地要求某人替自己做某件事
can — option	表示某個選項 / 安排在目前情況下可行
can't — inability	缺乏完成某項行動所需的能力
can't — prohibition	規則、權限或他人不允許某行動
can't be	根據證據判斷某件事不可能為真
can't have done	推斷某件過去的事情不可能發生過
can't help doing	無法阻止自己產生某行動 / 反應；忍不住
can't stand	對某人 / 某物極度不喜歡或無法忍受
can't afford	金錢不足，或某行動的代價 / 後果太高而不能承受
can't wait	非常期待某件事；迫不及待

can do	非正式表示自己能夠並願意完成某項要求	
a can	用金屬製成、用來盛裝食物 / 飲品等的容器	
can — preserve	把食物密封裝入罐中保存	
canned food	經密封裝罐保存的食品	
can someone	非正式美式英語：解僱某人	
can a project/show	非正式：取消、停止或放棄某計劃 / 製作	
the can	非正式俚語：廁所	
in the can	電影 / 節目等已完成拍攝或錄製	
can of worms	一個會引發多個互相關聯、棘手問題的複雜情況	

For your original passage

> “I want to ****learn from her while I can****.”

The exact meaning is:

****can = have the opportunity / be in circumstances that still allow something****

Therefore:

> ****while I can****

= ****「趁現在還可以 / 還有機會的時候」****

The key idea is ****not merely physical ability****.

You are not saying:

> “while my body is still capable of learning.”

The context tells us why:

> your grandmother is getting older

> → future visits are not guaranteed

> → your opportunity to learn directly from her is limited.

So ****can**** combines:

> opportunity

>

> * time

> * circumstances.

The natural meaning is therefore:

> **趁現在仍有機會**

The most important learner contrasts are:

> **I can swim.**

> = 我會游泳。

> → ability

> **I can see her tomorrow.**

> = 我明天可以 / 有機會見她。

> → opportunity

> **It can be difficult.**

> = 有時可能很困難。

> → possibility

> **You can leave now.**

> = 你現在可以走了。

> → permission

> **Can I come in?**

> = 我可以進來嗎？

> → request for permission

> **Can you help me?**

> = 你可以幫我嗎？

> → request

> **That can't be true.**

> = 那不可能是真的。

> → impossible inference

> **I can't help laughing.**

> = 我忍不住笑。

> **I can't stand the noise.**

> = 我受不了噪音。

> **I can't afford it.**

> = 我負擔不起。

> **I can't wait to see her.**

> = 我迫不及待想見她。

> **a can of soup**

> = 一罐湯

> **canned food**

> = 罐頭食品

> **He got canned.**

> = 他被炒魷魚了。(非正式)

> **They canned the project.**

> = 他們取消了項目。(非正式)

So **can** is far richer than simply:

> **can = 能 / 可以**

and in your original passage it specifically means:

***“while the opportunity still exists — before circumstances change and I no longer have the same chance to learn directly from her.”**